AIM AI IN MARKETING by Adsmentor

FREE CHECKLIST

AI announcement checklist for marketers

Four audiences, one honest message. From our Duolingo AI-first case study.

Use this before you tell anyone that AI is changing how you work: a team, freelancers, clients or the public. It takes about ten minutes and turns a worry into a plan.

The four-audience planner

Audience	What they usually fear	Say this first	Proof to give	Tell them
Your team	Losing their role; being judged on AI use	Which roles are not changing, and how AI use will or will not be judged	Training time in the calendar; a short written policy	First, in person or on a call
Freelancers and contractors	Work drying up without notice	What work stays with them, what changes, and from which date	A dated plan and a named person to ask	Before the public, privately
Customers and clients	Lower quality; impersonal replies	What AI helps with and who checks it	A human approval step; one real example	With the change, in plain words
Public and followers	A brand choosing cost over people	One short statement that matches your actions	The same facts, plus a follow-up date	After the first three groups know

What the Duolingo case shows. The April 2025 memo said the company would "gradually stop using contractors to do work that AI can handle" (Snopes, 6 May 2025). The CEO's later clarification said leaders should "provide clarity" and that "I didn't do that well" (Entrepreneur, 23 May 2025). The proof of benefit came first, the reassurance weeks later. Reverse that order.

Who is affected?

Person or group	What stays the same	What changes, and by when

The ten-point check before you post

- ☐ Have I listed everyone affected, by name or group?
- ☐ Do I know what will not change for each of them?
- ☐ Can I say what will change, and by what date?
- ☐ Is one named person answering questions, in one place?
- ☐ Can I show proof that quality is protected?
- ☐ Would I be comfortable if this were posted publicly tomorrow?
- ☐ Is the first sentence the one a worried person needs?
- ☐ Have the most affected people heard it before everyone else?
- ☐ Have I put the follow-up dates in my calendar?
- ☐ Have I chosen three numbers to watch for 30 days?

Your 120-word statement

Write one sentence for each line. Keep each under 25 words. Read it aloud as the most worried person would hear it.

1. What is changing: From [date], we will use AI to help with _____ (name the tasks).

2. What is not changing: _____ (roles, people, quality checks, prices) stay the same.

3. Who checks the work: A person at _____ reviews every _____ before it reaches a customer.

4. What it means for the people affected: If you work with us on _____, you will hear from _____ by [date] about what this means for you.

5. How to reach us and when we will update you: Questions go to _____. We will share an update on [date] covering _____.

Words to avoid

- ☐ Vague claims such as "streamlining" or "efficiency" with no plain meaning.
- ☐ Promises you cannot keep, such as "no one will be affected".
- ☐ Announcing a decision as final before you have talked to those it touches.
- ☐ Humour or silence as the first public response to worry.

The 30-day follow-up plan

When	Do this	Done
Day 0	Tell the most affected people privately. Then your team, clients and public in that order.	☐
Day 2	Read every reply and comment. Answer questions in the same place they were asked.	☐
Day 7	Publish the promised update, even if it says "no change yet". Fix anything people found unclear.	☐
Day 14	Compare your three numbers with day 0. Check quality on a sample of AI-assisted work.	☐
Day 30	Write down what you would say differently next time. Share what changed with the people affected.	☐

Three numbers to watch

Number	Day 0	Day 14	Day 30
Replies and questions received			
Unsubscribes or unfollows			
Reviews or client feedback (good and bad)			

What Duolingo's own letters show

- ☐ Course units published: 1,800 per quarter in 2024, 7,100 per quarter in 2025, 20,500 in Q1 2026 (Q1 2026 letter).
- ☐ Daily users: 50.5 million in Q3 2025 and 64.9 million in Q3 2026 (Q3 2025 and Q3 2026 letters).
- ☐ Reasons it gave for slower 2025 growth: monetisation friction, and posting less playful social content (Q4 2025 and Q3 2025 letters). The letters do not credit or blame the memo.

Sources: Duolingo shareholder letters filed with the SEC (Q3 2025, Q4 2025, Q1 2026, Q3 2026); Snopes via Yahoo (6 May 2025); Entrepreneur (23 May 2025); PR Daily (28 May 2025); TechCrunch (7 August 2025). Full case study: aiinmarketing.in/blogs/duolingo-ai-first-case-study-18-months-on